Ideology of Pakistan

The term ideology was coined by Antoine deStrutt de Tracy during the French Revolution (1789). It meant a 'science of ideas'. Justice Muhammad Munir explained, without direct reference to de Tracy, that ideology is the science which deals with beliefs, notions and theories. These in turn have their origin in fundamental assumptions held by a people. These ideas may be naturally acquired and sometimes they may be consciously spread.

The ideology of the French Revolution was summed up as *equality, fraternity* and *liberty*. It overthrew the theory of the Divine Right of Kings. According to Charles E. Bressler, ideology refers to 'the collective or social consciousness of a culture'. This is opposed to the material reality on which an experience is based. This means that though the ideology of Pakistan has been derived from the Two-Nation Theory (see Chapter 20) it is not identical to it. In other words, the ideology of Pakistan is enshrined, not in the Lahore Resolution, but in the Objectives Resolution (see Part VI).

An ideology is expressed in absolute terms, not relative terms. The Two-Nation Theory is relative because it depends on the existence of the 'other', in our case, the Hindu majority in undivided India. If the Hindus had not existed, or if they had existed as a minority, then there would have been no occasion to propound the Two-Nation Theory according to which Hindus and Muslims form different nations.

Islamic ideology means to order our individual and collective behaviour in accordance with the Islamic concepts of justice, morality, human rights and tolerance. Human rights are an important component of Islam. Rights of God and rights of worshippers are clearly demarcated. There are sins against God such as neglecting prayer, fasting and pilgrimage. There are sins against human beings such as stealing from them, killing them or even backbiting against which the Holy Quran has issued the severest strictures. Islamic ideology is a matter of personal conscience as well as social behaviour.

Islamic ideology is different from the other ideologies of the twentieth century. Islam upholds the right of private property and encourages the professions of trade and commerce. Still, it is not akin to capitalism, because it considers usury or interest a sin. An interest-free economy cannot exist within the capitalist system.

Although Islam decries the concentration of wealth and enjoins *zakat* and *ushr*, to take from the rich to pay the poor, to aim for social justice, it is different from communism because it does not subscribe to the atheism of communism, nor does it believe in the regimentation of society. Since both capitalism and communism historically came much after Islam, it must be clear that Islam has not borrowed from them, instead both capitalism and communism have borrowed from Islam. The Islamic ideology of Pakistan does not mean discrimination against non-Muslims but the protection of their rights.

PAKISTAN STUDIES

for

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